Four Nations, One Identity: How does devolution work?

Target Audience: B1+ / B2 (Upper-Intermediate)
Time: 60 minutes
Approach: CLIL (Content and Language Integrated Learning) + Socio-cultural approach (Safonova's "Dialogue of Cultures")
Methodological Framework: TBL (Task-Based Learning) with elements of Guided Discovery.

Lesson Objectives:

- Educational (Content): Students will understand the difference between "The United Kingdom", "Great Britain", and "England", and learn about the concept of *devolution*.
- Linguistic (Language): Students will practice vocabulary related to politics and geography (e.g., *devolution, parliament, sovereign, identity, constituent country*) and develop reading and speaking skills.
- Socio-cultural (Safonova's approach): Students will develop cultural sensitivity, realize why it is crucial not to confuse national identities, and compare the UK's structure with their own country's structure (Dialogue of Cultures).

Stage	Stage aim	Timing	Procedure	Aids and materials
Warm-up	Activate background knowledge and introduce the core cultural conflict.	5-7 min	**Task 1:** The "Map Trap". Teacher shows a map of the British Isles. Asks: *"How many countries are there?"* (Students often say one: England). **Task 2:** Problem Scenario. Teacher says: *"Imagine you meet a person from Edinburgh. You say: 'Oh, so you are English!' The person gets offended. Why?"* Students brainstorm in pairs.	Map of the British Isles on the screen/board.

Lead-in	Pre-teach essential vocabulary and set the context (CLIL focus).	8 min	Task 1: Vocabulary Match. Students match words with definitions: *devolution, sovereign, constituent country, identity*. Task 2: Prediction. Students look at the title *"Four Nations, One Identity"* and guess what the four nations are.	Vocabulary worksheet / presentation slide.
While-Viewing	Develop listening/viewing skills for specific information (scanning).	6 min	Students watch a short authentic video (CGP Grey clip). They fill in the table: *Country / Capital / Has its own Parliament?* First viewing: Students watch the video and fill in the table with the Capitals (London, Edinburgh, Cardiff, Belfast). Second viewing (if needed): Teacher pauses the video at key moments to help students identify which countries have their own parliaments (Yes/No).	presentation, The UK Is a ...
Post-Viewing	Check comprehension and provide a bridge to the next activity.	4 min	Peer Check & Discuss. Students compare their tables in pairs. Teacher elicits answers. *Question:* "Did any of the answers surprise you?"	The completed table
Pre-Reading	Set the purpose for reading the text.	3 min	*Teacher's instruction:* "The video showed us that they have parliaments. But it didn't explain why. Let's read the text to find out." Students have 1 minute to skim the text and find the general answer (e.g., "people wanted more control"). Teacher elicits the answer orally.	Presentation, text, What is devolution and how does it work across the UK? - BBC Newsround

Reading	Develop reading skills for detailed understanding of the concept of devolution.	7 min	Students read the text carefully and answer the question in their own words: *"Why did the UK government decide to give power to local parliaments?"*	Presentation, text
Post-Reading (production)	Apply knowledge, develop critical thinking through the "Dialogue of Cultures"	13 min	Task 1: Role-Play "Tourist Guide". Group work. Create a 4-rule "Survival Guide" for tourists on how to address people so they don't offend anyone. Task 2: Dialogue of Cultures. Compare the UK's structure with the students' home country: *Does your country have regions with special rights?*	Tourist Survival Guide, blanks, presentation
Homework and feedback	Summarize, consolidate, and reflect on cultural importance.	5 min	Reflection: *"Why is it important to know the difference between the UK and England?"* Homework: Write a 100-word social media post as a Scottish person explaining why they are not English.	Board/ presentation slide students' notebooks.

Lead-in:

Task: Match the words (1-4) with their definitions (A-D).

1. Devolution _____
2. Sovereign _____
3. Constituent country _____
4. Identity _____

Definitions:

- A. The qualities, beliefs, and culture that make a person or a group different from others.
- B. A country that is part of a larger political union (e.g., Scotland in the UK).

- C. The process of transferring power from a central government to regional governments.
- D. Having supreme power or authority.

(Answer Key for Teachers: 1-C, 2-D, 3-B, 4-A)

While-Viewing:

Country	**Capital**	**Does it have its own Parliament?**
England		*(Yes/No)*
Scotland		*(Yes/No)*
Wales		*(Yes/No)*
Northern Ireland		*(Yes/No)*

Answer Key for Teachers:

Country	**Capital**	**Does it have its own parliament? (Yes/No)**
England	London	No *(It is governed directly by the UK Parliament in London)*
Scotland	Edinburgh	Yes *(The Scottish Parliament)*
Wales	Cardiff	Yes *(The Welsh Parliament / Senedd)*
Northern Ireland	Belfast	Yes *(The Northern Ireland Assembly)*

What is Devolution?

(Adapted from BBC Newsround)

The United Kingdom is made up of four nations: England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland. For many years the four nations were run by one government, known as the UK government, based in Westminster in London.

But increasingly, more people wanted their nation to have more control over the decisions made in their part of the UK. By the end of the 1990s, something called devolution happened.

In 1997 and 1998, public votes were held in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland. People were voting on whether their nation should have more power. Most people wanted that option - so it was decided that powers should be passed from the central UK parliament in London to elected groups in Cardiff, Belfast and Edinburgh. These elected groups are called the Scottish Parliament, the Welsh Parliament (Senedd) and the Northern Ireland Assembly.

They all have the power to make some big decisions for their nation, instead of being ruled entirely by the UK government. The main issues the nations' governments have control over are things like education, housing, environment and health.

However, they don't all have the same powers, and some powers are not devolved. These are called reserved powers. The UK government in London is still responsible for making decisions on foreign affairs, defence, international relations and economic policy.

Question: According to the text, why did the UK government decide to give power to local parliaments?

- Expected Answer (in students' own words): Because people in Scotland, Wales, and Northern Ireland wanted more control over the decisions made in their part of the UK. They voted for it in public votes (referendums) in 1997 and 1998, and the majority wanted this option.

Additional Comprehension Questions

Question 1: What is the name of the process where power is passed from the central government to local governments?

- Answer: Devolution.

Question 2: Which four nations make up the United Kingdom?

- Answer: England, Scotland, Wales, and Northern Ireland.

Question 3: Where does the central UK government meet?

- Answer: In Westminster, London.

Question 4: Name three areas that the local parliaments (Scottish, Welsh, Northern Irish) have control over.

- Answer: Education, housing, environment, health (any three of these).

Question 5: What are "reserved powers"? Name two areas that the UK government in London still controls.

- Answer: Reserved powers are powers that are NOT devolved. The UK government still controls foreign affairs, defence, international relations, and economic policy (any two of these).

Tourist Survival Guide

Group Name: _____
Country you are visiting: The United Kingdom

Task: You work for a UK travel agency. Write 4 rules for foreign tourists on how to address people from the UK so they don't offend anyone. Use the information from the video and the text.

Rule 1: _____
Rule 2: _____
Rule 3: _____
Rule 4: _____

Example: Don't call a person from Scotland "English". Call them "Scottish" or "British".